

Charter

Wake Up San Francisco

The Charter aims to provide the roles, rhythm and process to bring harmony to the community, provide accountability for financial management and ensure stable continuation over time. In short, our vision for managing a growing Wake Up Sangha responsibly.

We've decided to wait to implement these changes until a later date to be determined in 2021.

Completed by Charter Committee: October 7, 2020

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Article I - About Wake Up

Wake Up is an active global community of young mindfulness practitioners, aged 18-35+, inspired by the teachings of Zen Master and peace activist Thich Nhat Hanh. We are part of a worldwide movement of young Buddhists and non-Buddhists practicing mindful living in the Plum Village tradition.

Section 1.1 - Mission

We come together to practice mindfulness in order to take care of ourselves, nourish happiness, and contribute to building a healthier and a more compassionate society.

We aim to experience joy and ease in our pursuits, keeping it real with the laughter, sanity, and friendship that bloom from practicing mindfulness together.

Section 1.2 - Values

See the Five Mindfulness Trainings (Article IX).

Article II - Decision Making and Roles

Our group is composed of our members, the Care Taking Council (CTC), the Board of Advisors and the Board of Directors.

In making decisions, we prefer harmony over speed. We are committed to making decisions that broadly impact the community based on unanimous consent when reasonably possible.

When there may be more than one opinion, we practice listening deeply to everyone's views. We investigate the issues of our community, speak up both when we don't agree and when we have an insight to add.

Decision-making is based on "consent," rather than "consensus;" meaning that the operative question in consenting to a proposal is: "is this a reasonable measure?" rather than "is this perfect and do I agree completely?" Consent is about asking each individual to compromise with the group, rather than asking the entire group to compromise with an individual.

The intention is to equalize people's sense of ownership to influence the organization and give voice to all members of the community.

Section 2.1 - Membership

A Member is any person aged 18-35 who has attended at least four (4) Sangha meetings in the past one (1) year, has expressed a wish to make a formal commitment to Wake Up SF and whose application is approved by the CTC.

Members shall have one year terms and membership shall be renewed annually.

Every member has a right to vote as outlined in Elections (see Article III) and on any proposals in an Open Meeting (see section 4.2).

Membership may be suspended at any time in cases of a breach of trust or conduct detrimental to the organization. A suspension shall not last for longer than one (1) year without approval from an Open Meeting.

Membership may be permanently revoked, resulting in a ban or other such measures, by an Open Meeting.

See [Membership Application and Renewal Form](#)

Section 2.2 - Care Taking Council (CTC)

The Care Taking Council are elected members serving the community.

Responsibilities of the CTC include day-to-day operations, recruiting and training new members, content creation, website and social media management, organizing meetings or events, collecting Dana and fundraising.

The CTC is also tasked with putting forward major proposals, such as amending By-Laws or Charter, to the community for ratification at Open Meetings. They have the power to create any committees or roles needed by the community and to appoint the individuals to fill them.

The CTC has the authority to temporarily suspend any member.

Individually, they are empowered to make operating decisions for the community as deemed reasonable by the scope of their role.

Section 2.3 - Board of Directors

The Board of Directors, also known as The Board, are legally responsible for the organization. The Care Taking Council and the entire organization reports to The Board.

Final approval of changes in the Bylaws and Charter rests with the Board of Directors.

The Board is also responsible for selecting the Board of Advisors and the size of the CTC.

The Board of Directors shall be three (3). The Board must include the roles of Chair of the Board, Treasurer, and Secretary. The Chair of the Board may not serve as the Treasurer.

Directors shall be between the ages of 18-40, and either a current member or an Alumni of Wake Up.

Section 2.3.1 - Term

Each member of The Board shall serve staggered terms of three (3) years so that approximately one-third shall be elected every year.

Section 2.3.2 - Removal

Any Director may be removed without cause if such removal is approved by the majority of the directors then in office.

Section 2.3.3 - Vacancy

In the event a member chooses to terminate or is unable to complete their term, the Board may appoint a replacement or call a new election.

Section 2.4 - Board of Advisors

Considered an Advisory Committee, the Board of Advisors helps to provide 3rd party oversight of finances and elections, form recommendations and partner with the greater community.

Section 2.4.1 - Term

The Board of Advisors shall be no smaller than two (2) and no greater than eight (8). They shall serve staggered terms of three (3) years so that approximately one-third shall be elected every year.

Section 2.4.2 - Representation and Experience

The Board of Advisors seeks representation from each of the following parts of the Four-Fold Sangha: Alumni of Wake Up, all-ages laypeople, Order of Interbeing / Dharma Teachers and monastic.

The Board of Advisors has a preference for experienced practitioners in the Plum Village tradition living in the local area and for those serving an official capacity in the Plum Village Community of Engaged Buddhism.

Section 2.4.3 - Removal

Advisors may be removed by The Board for lack of engagement, conduct detrimental to the organization or any behavior deemed inappropriate.

Section 2.5 - Alumni and Age

Wake Up is committed to creating a space of warmth, energy and inclusion for practitioners 18-35 years old. Alumni are people who are above 35 years old and was previously a member of Wake Up.

For Wake Up Alumni, we invite them to ask the following questions in regards to attendance:

In a group of Wake Uppers, does my voice hinder their expressions and need for connection around issues faced in their daily life and how mindfulness practice for them is learned and applied?

- If the answer is “Yes,” then that is when we ask you to take care of your needs somewhere else.

Are there times I can respectfully join the conversation, will be of help, and support my own needs for connection and support based on my life experience?

- If the answer is “Yes,” then that is we invite you to participate.

Those who are 36 years old on the day of an Election (see Article III) must refrain from voting and running for the CTC.

Article III - Elections

Section 3.1 - Annual Elections

Approximately one-third of the Board and the entire CTC shall be elected annually, which may be done in an Open Meeting (see section 4.2) or through electronic ballot on or before December 1st of each year.

Section 3.2 - Open Nomination

Nominations to be a candidate for the Board or CTC should be submitted to the Board in early October and include a short description of why a candidate is being nominated. A person may nominate themselves.

Any member of the community may serve, as long as they have the intention and capacity to serve and meet the requirements as stated below.

Candidates for the CTC shall be members between 18-35 the day of the election.

Candidates for the Board shall be members or alumni 40 or younger on the day of the election.

All candidates shall live or be rooted in the Bay Area.

A person may serve on both the CTC and the Board simultaneously.

After nominations are collected, they are celebrated by being published to the Sangha in a way that waters the seeds of community for all. At this time, the Sangha shall be asked if they have any objections to the nominees for the board to review.

Section 3.3 - Review for Qualifications

The Board, with input from the Sangha and in consultation with the Board of Advisors, shall review the nominations for the Board and CTC and finalize a ballot of candidates.

The Board is encouraged to develop, maintain and publish guidelines for qualification.

Section 3.4 - Non-Campaigning and Non-Partisan

Members are urged not to create division in order to influence an Election. Candidates are discouraged from actively or openly campaigning for office.

Section 3.5- Notice of Elections

The community shall receive notice with a full list of candidates published at least fourteen (14) days prior to Elections.

Section 3.6 - Notice and Other Deadlines

Nominations for Office: Early October

Nominees Published: Late October

Notice of Election: at least 14 days before Elections and 14 days after Nominees Published
Elections: on or before December 1st
Last Day in Office: December 31st

Section 3.7 - CTC Term

Each officer shall be elected for a term of one (1) year(s) or until a successor has been elected.

The term of office of each officer shall end on December 31st of the year following their election.

Section 3.8 - CTC Offices

Elections shall not stipulate a specific office for each candidate. Offices are decided after the CTC is elected by the then newly elected CTC.

The Care Taking Council shall include the following offices:

- Head of Practice
- Finance Coordinator
- Social Coordinator

Section 3.8.1 - Head of Practice

The Head of Practice shall have the responsibility of holding space, introducing practices, training facilitators, maintaining schedules and allocating facilitators as needed. The role shall be responsible for facilitating meetings, procuring a space to practice and other logistics as deemed necessary to coordinate and organize the community.

Section 3.8.2 - Finance Coordinator

The Finance Director is responsible for adequate and correct books and accounts of the Corporation's properties and transactions.

The Treasurer shall lead the fundraising efforts of the community to maintain enough funds to operate without incurring debt and to support the Plum Village community. The Treasurer may maintain all financial accounts (such as Paypal, Venmo and bank accounts) in a transparent manner.

Section 3.8.3 - Social Coordinator

The Social Coordinator shall be responsible for gathering the community to celebrate, raise funds and otherwise promote a sense of kinship and joy.

Section 3.9 - Vacancy

In the event a member chooses to terminate or is unable to complete their term, the CTC may appoint a replacement or call a new election.

Section 3.10 - Removal

Officers may be permanently removed through an Open Meeting or by the Board for misconduct or failure to perform the duties of the office.

Section 3.11 - Appointments

The CTC may create appointed roles as they deem appropriate to best serve the needs of the community.

Appointed roles serve at the pleasure of the CTC.

Article IV - Organization

Section 4.1 - Board Meetings

The Board shall meet with the CTC at least once per season or at least four (4) times per year for the purpose of review of accounts, approval of expenses, reflecting and setting goals.

Board Meetings must approve any expense above \$2,000 accrued per annum and the causes eligible to be supported by fundraising.

Section 4.1.1 - Quorum for Board Meetings

A majority of the total number of directors for the Board shall constitute a quorum for the transaction of business. Every action taken or decision made by unanimous consent of those present at a meeting duly at which a quorum is present shall be regarded as the act of the The Board.

Section 4.2 - Open Meetings

Open Meetings have the authority to change elected officials, permanently remove individual members and to amend Bylaws or Charter.

Open Meetings must approve any expense above \$10,000 accrued per annum.

Open meetings may be called by a majority of the CTC or the Board.

Section 4.2.1 - Notice

Calling an Open Meeting requires at least 2-weeks notice for all members of the organization along with a description of any proposals to be considered.

Such notification shall be made with reasonable effort to all channels of communication and, at minimum, be communicated via email.

Section 4.2.2 - Quorum

Each duly convened general meeting has a quorum regardless of the number of members present. Every action taken or decision made by unanimous consent of the members present at a meeting duly at which quorum is present shall be regarded as the act of the community.

Section 4.3 - Procedure

Section 4.3.1 - Beginning Business Meetings

“Dear Elders and Teachers over many generations:

We make the commitment to go through this meeting in a spirit of togetherness as we review all ideas and consolidate them to a consensus. We will use the methods of loving speech and deep listening in order to bring about the success of this meeting. We will not hesitate to share our ideas and insights, but we will also not say anything when the feeling of irritation is present in us. We are resolutely determined not to allow tension to build up in this meeting. If any one of us senses the start of tension, we will stop immediately and address it.”

Section 4.3.2 - Sanghakarman

Sanghakarman is the suggested procedure for delivering unanimous consent. Most decisions in Plum Village Sanghas should be made by the Sangha’s core community using the Sanghakarman — Sangha body — procedure.

- Step #1 - Prior to the meeting set and distribute an agenda. Members should contact the facilitator to add items to the agenda.
- Step #2 - Facilitator describes the proposal during the meeting.
- Step #3 - Facilitator opens the floor for opinions and ideas on the proposal.
- Step #4 - When the discussion is complete, the facilitator restates the resulting proposal and asks if there is further discussion.

- Step #5 - Facilitator asks, "If the Sangha agrees with this proposal, please remain silent for three breaths. If anyone has a different idea, please speak up now." They may choose to repeat this up to three times.
- Step #6 - Once three breaths have passed, the proposal has been accepted by Sangha consensus and the bell master invites the bell.
- Step #7 - Facilitator thanks the Sangha and proceeds to the next item on the agenda.

Once a decision is made based on consensus, all Sangha members are expected to help carry it out in the spirit of respect and harmony.

Article V - Operating

Section 5.1 - Sangha

Regular service shall be maintained on a weekly basis, as much as practical and in accordance to holidays, and to practice for not more than 2.5 hours on a designated time of the week. It is recommended that Sangha be open to the public, however Sangha may be closed to the public at the discretion of the CTC.

Sangha may be located in the same physical location as much as possible.

Section 5.1.2 - Reciting the Five Mindfulness Trainings

At least once every three months the Five Mindfulness Trainings shall be read, introduced or discussed (see Article IX).

Section 5.2 - Socials

For the purposes of building joy in the community or fundraising for the organization, or for causes supported by the organization, Wake Up maintains a regular social practice that may occur monthly or as deemed appropriate and is open to all members of the organization and invited guests.

Section 5.3 - Facilitator 101

New members may request a mentor to help teach them the methods of facilitating a sangha meeting: holding space, guiding meditation, facilitating dharma discussions and dharma sharing.

Prior to facilitating a sangha meeting, a member must have either facilitated before or have had at least one (1) session with a mentor.

Section 5.4 - Public Practice

As needed, the membership of Wake Up may opt-in to helping bring the practice into public spaces by opening Sangha meetings to the public, participating in protests, flash meditations or actions as otherwise deemed necessary and in line with the values of compassionate, nonviolent direct action.

Section 5.5 - Stepping Onto and Off the Mountain

At the conclusion of annual elections, the organization may perform a ritual to pass on the responsibility of community-building.

Members who are Stepping Onto the Mountain may be suggested to take the following vow:

“Aware that the essence and aim of a Sangha is the practice of understanding and compassion, we are determined not to use the community for personal power or profit, or transform our community into a political instrument. As members of a spiritual community, we should nonetheless take a clear stand against oppression and injustice. We should strive to change the situation, without taking sides in a conflict.

We are committed to learning to look with the eyes of interbeing and to see ourselves and others as cells in one body. By generating mindfulness, concentration, and insight to nourish ourselves and the whole community, we will actively build brotherhood and sisterhood, flow as a river, and practice to develop the three real powers – understanding, love, and cutting through afflictions – to realize collective awakening.”

Article VI - Intentions

Section 6.1 - Diversity and Inclusion

Wake Up is committed to diversity and inclusion across our organization. We stand in solidarity with those who suffer from racism, sexism, homophobia, ableism, and all forms of discrimination based on notions of separateness. We will take active measures to ensure that a wide variety of views are represented and included.

Section 6.2 - Youth and Sexual Abuse

Understanding that Wake Up is a young adults organization and may come into contact with young practitioners more often, we are committed to doing everything in our power to protect

children from sexual abuse and to protect couples and families from being broken by sexual misconduct.

Article VII - Best Efforts

We are aware that this is a living document which captures the spirit of our intentions: stability, representation, inclusion, and fairness. We realize that we may encounter challenges or situations that we did not foresee. The CTC will be responsible for handling those cases by prioritizing harmony and consensus while meeting the needs of the community in a timely manner, with oversight from the Board.

We also empower our individual members to say something to the CTC should they notice anything wrong, and if they are uncomfortable doing so, to contact the Board of Advisors or Board of Directors.

Article VIII - Charter, Bylaw & List of Officers

Section 8.1 - Availability

A copy of the most recently adopted Charter, Bylaws and a list of the members of the CTC, Board of Advisors, Board of Directors and their contact information shall be available to members at all times.

Section 8.2 - Amendments

Amendments to the Bylaws or Charter, must be ratified in an Open Meeting.

Article IX - Five Mindfulness Trainings

The Five Mindfulness Trainings represent the Buddhist vision for a global spirituality and ethic.

They offer a guide to the path of right understanding and true love, leading to healing, transformation, and happiness for ourselves and for the world. To practice the Five Mindfulness Trainings is to cultivate the insight of interbeing which can remove discrimination, intolerance, anger, fear, and despair.

The Five Mindfulness Trainings gives us an aspirational path forward.

Section 9.1 - Reverence For Life

Aware of the suffering caused by the destruction of life, I am committed to cultivating the insight of interbeing and compassion and learning ways to protect the lives of people, animals, plants, and minerals.

I am determined not to kill, not to let others kill, and not to support any act of killing in the world, in my thinking, or in my way of life.

Seeing that harmful actions arise from anger, fear, greed, and intolerance, which in turn come from dualistic and discriminative thinking, I will cultivate openness, non-discrimination, and non-attachment to views in order to transform violence, fanaticism, and dogmatism in myself and in the world.

Section 9.2 - True Happiness

Aware of the suffering caused by exploitation, social injustice, stealing, and oppression, I am committed to practicing generosity in my thinking, speaking, and acting.

I am determined not to steal and not to possess anything that should belong to others; and I will share my time, energy, and material resources with those who are in need.

I will practice looking deeply to see that the happiness and suffering of others are not separate from my own happiness and suffering; that true happiness is not possible without understanding and compassion; and that running after wealth, fame, power and sensual pleasures can bring much suffering and despair.

I am aware that happiness depends on my mental attitude and not on external conditions, and that I can live happily in the present moment simply by remembering that I already have more than enough conditions to be happy.

I am committed to practicing Right Livelihood so that I can help reduce the suffering of living beings on Earth and reverse the process of global warming.

Section 9.3 - True Love

Aware of the suffering caused by sexual misconduct, I am committed to cultivating responsibility and learning ways to protect the safety and integrity of individuals, couples, families, and society.

Knowing that sexual desire is not love, and that sexual activity motivated by craving always harms myself as well as others, I am determined not to engage in sexual relations without true love and a deep, long-term commitment made known to my family and friends.

I will do everything in my power to protect children from sexual abuse and to prevent couples and families from being broken by sexual misconduct.

Seeing that body and mind are one, I am committed to learning appropriate ways to take care of my sexual energy and cultivating loving kindness, compassion, joy and inclusiveness – which are the four basic elements of true love – for my greater happiness and the greater happiness of others.

Practicing true love, we know that we will continue beautifully into the future.

Section 9.4 - Loving Speech and Deep Listening

Aware of the suffering caused by unmindful speech and the inability to listen to others, I am committed to cultivating loving speech and compassionate listening in order to relieve suffering and to promote reconciliation and peace in myself and among other people, ethnic and religious groups, and nations.

Knowing that words can create happiness or suffering, I am committed to speaking truthfully using words that inspire confidence, joy, and hope.

When anger is manifesting in me, I am determined not to speak. I will practice mindful breathing and walking in order to recognize and to look deeply into my anger. I know that the roots of anger can be found in my wrong perceptions and lack of understanding of the suffering in myself and in the other person. I will speak and listen in a way that can help myself and the other person to transform suffering and see the way out of difficult situations.

I am determined not to spread news that I do not know to be certain and not to utter words that can cause division or discord. I will practice Right Diligence to nourish my capacity for understanding, love, joy, and inclusiveness, and gradually transform anger, violence, and fear that lie deep in my consciousness.

Section 9.5 - Nourishment and Healing

Aware of the suffering caused by unmindful consumption, I am committed to cultivating good health, both physical and mental, for myself, my family, and my society by practicing mindful eating, drinking, and consuming.

I will practice looking deeply into how I consume the Four Kinds of Nutriment, namely edible foods, sense impressions, volition, and consciousness.

I am determined not to gamble, or to use alcohol, drugs, or any other products which contain toxins, such as certain websites, electronic games, TV programs, films, magazines, books, and conversations.

I will practice coming back to the present moment to be in touch with the refreshing, healing and nourishing elements in me and around me, not letting regrets and sorrow drag me back into the past nor letting anxieties, fear, or craving pull me out of the present moment.

I am determined not to try to cover up loneliness, anxiety, or other suffering by losing myself in consumption. I will contemplate interbeing and consume in a way that preserves peace, joy, and well-being in my body and consciousness, and in the collective body and consciousness of my family, my society and the Earth.

Note from the Editor

I wanted to say thank you and congratulations to everyone who scrubbed in to finalize the Charter that may begin to take Wake Up SF forward next year. Collectively we've met 10 times over three months and spent over 90 person-hours to discuss how to more beautifully continue Wake Up in a more sustainable fashion. That doesn't take into account all the work to write, edit, and comment from people in this group.

-Chris Pham

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